BUTTERNUT SQUASH AND MARJORAM RAVIOLI

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
4	**1 h 30 min**

INGREDIENTS

4	Pasta — large eggs, organic
150 g	Pasta — 00 flour
50 g	Pasta — fine semolina (+ extra for dusting)
1	Ravioli Filling — small butternut squash
1	Ravioli Filling — garlic clove, sliced
1 tbsp	Ravioli Filling — fresh marjoram, chopped
125 g	Ravioli Filling — unsalted butter
1/4	Ravioli Filling — nutmeg, grated
100 g	Ravioli Filling — mascarpone
to taste	Ravioli Filling — salt and pepper
1 bunch	Sage & Gorgonzola Sauce — sage, roughly chopped
100 g	Sage & Gorgonzola Sauce — Gorgonzola dolce latte

METHOD

1. Make pasta dough: Add 3 egg yolks and 1 whole egg to a blender with the semolina and flour. Gradually pulse the mixture until it forms a smooth, firm dough ball that is slightly sticky to the touch. If the dough is a little wet, add a little more flour. Split the dough into 2 portions, wrap in cling film and store in the fridge to chill.
2. Prepare filling: Peel and de-seed the butternut squash, then cut into small dice and add to a pan of salted boiling water until cooked through. Once ready, drain and set aside in a colander to cool.
3. Cook squash: Heat half of the butter in a pan until foaming, then add the garlic. Cook until soft, then add the butternut squash and chopped marjoram. Cook for approximately 10 minutes, gently mashing the butternut squash with a wooden spoon as it cooks. The mixture should dry out as the liquid evaporates.
4. Finish filling: At this point, add the nutmeg, mascarpone and salt and pepper, stir well and leave to cool.
5. Roll pasta: Remove the pasta from the fridge at least 1 hour before rolling out. Use a pasta machine to roll the pasta out as thinly as possible, ensuring the sheet is no larger than 12cm x 60cm in size.
6. Form ravioli: Place a heaped teaspoon of filling down the length of one side of the pasta, making sure there is enough pasta to fold over the mixture to seal the ravioli and leaving a 3cm gap around each portion. Brush some water between the piles of filling to help the pasta seal, then fold the length of the pasta over the filling to meet the other edge. Using your 2 little fingers, gently press down the pasta around each ball of mixture to make a seal. Ensure there is no air trapped in the ravioli, or they will explode.
7. Cut and cook: Using a ravioli cutter or knife, cut out the ravioli and press each individual raviolo so the seal is tight and all the air has been pressed out. Bring a large pan of salted water to the boil and add the ravioli, cook for 3-5 minutes until al dente.
8. Make sauce and serve: Meanwhile, melt the rest of the butter in a frying pan until lightly browned. Add the sage and Gorgonzola and stir through to form the sauce. Drain the ravioli, add to the pan of sauce and toss to coat. Divide onto plates and serve immediately.

NOTES

Get the pasta machine out of the cupboard and attempt this Autumnal butternut squash ravioli recipe from Theo Randall. A wonderful vegetarian dish to enjoy as a light lunch or supper. The combination of sweet squash, aromatic marjoram, and tangy Gorgonzola is simply divine.
Chef's Tips: The key is ensuring no air gets trapped in the ravioli - they'll explode during cooking. The mascarpone makes the filling creamy and rich, while the Gorgonzola sauce adds a wonderful tangy contrast to the sweet squash.

FILLING

Butternut Squash and Marjoram Filling

INGREDIENTS

1	Small butternut squash
1	Garlic clove, sliced
1 tbsp	Fresh marjoram, chopped
125 g	Unsalted butter
1/4	Nutmeg, grated
100 g	Mascarpone
to taste	Salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Peel and deseed the squash, cut it into small dice, and boil in salted water until cooked through. Drain in a colander and cool.
2. Foam half the butter in a pan and soften the garlic in it.
3. Add the squash and marjoram and cook about 10 minutes, mashing gently with a wooden spoon as the liquid evaporates.
4. Stir in the nutmeg, mascarpone, salt and pepper and leave to cool.

NOTES

> The 125 g of butter is shared with the sauce. Half foams the garlic here, and the source browns the rest for the sage and Gorgonzola sauce.
> Step 3 is a drying step as much as a cooking one. The mix has to lose its liquid or the ravioli explode.
> A heaped teaspoon per portion, spaced 3 cm apart along one side of the sheet, with water brushed between the piles to seal.
> The mascarpone is what makes it rich, and the source pairs that against the tang of the Gorgonzola sauce.

SHAPE

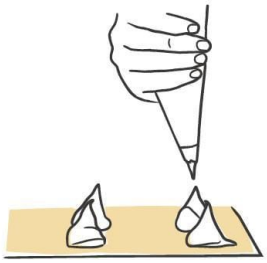
Ravioli

Region: All of Italy, north to south, and worldwide / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Trim the sheets to 18-inch lengths with a knife and cut away the ragged edges. Save the scraps for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet on the board. Using a pastry bag cut to a 1-inch opening, pipe mounds of filling roughly 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high in an even run down the sheet, leaving about 2 inches between mounds.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist it with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board so the second sheet will stick. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Lay a second sheet gently over the first, edges lined up and no wrinkles.
7. Press around each mound with your two index fingers to expel the air pockets. For insurance, flip a #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter to its dull side and press gently over each mound to expel the last of the air.
8. For square ravioli, cut 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted pastry cutter or fluted dough divider. A 2 1/2-inch fluted square cutter does the same thing.
9. For round ravioli, use a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter. Press straight down with your palm flat on top of the cutter, then twist it clockwise under that pressure to finish the cut.
10. Lift the sheets from one end to peel away the surrounding scrap. Discard it or save it for soup.
11. Set the pieces on the prepared pan in a single layer and dust the pan again with semolina.
12. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
13. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

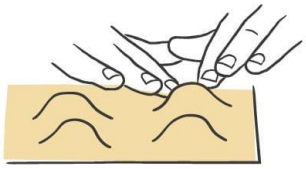
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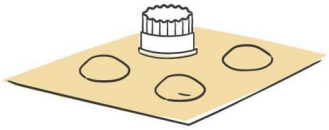
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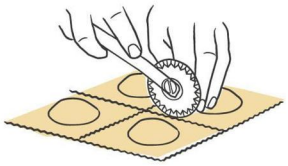
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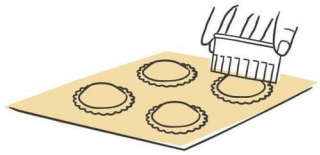
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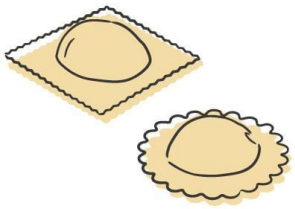
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NOTES

Two-sheet construction from 18-inch sheets. The filling goes on the bottom sheet and a second sheet covers it.
Filling per piece: a mound 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high, piped through a 1-inch opening.
Spacing: mounds 2 inches apart. The cut is either a 2 1/2-inch square or a 2 3/8-inch round.
Cutters: #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter used dull side down to expel air, then either a fluted cutter or divider for 2 1/2-inch squares, or a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter for rounds.
Cutting technique for rounds: press with a flat palm, then rotate clockwise under pressure so the cut goes all the way through.
Air is expelled twice before cutting, first with two index fingers and then with the dull cutter.
The author's restaurant version is round, roughly 2 inches across, with a ruffled edge. The square version is the red-sauce shape.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Red sauce is the default finish. Otherwise the shape is a test bed for any filling.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.